

Mike: Cohen Never Pulled Stupid Play

FIRST MEMORY OF ANDY COHEN IS A SPRING-time homerun he hit over the left field fence at Waco, Texas.

This was the clincher that got him a contract with the New York Giants. It caused manager John McGraw to say, "At last! I've been looking for a good Jewish ball player for the New York fans all these years; and now I've got him."



CULLUM'S COLUMN
by
DICK CULLUM

They knew nearly everything about Andy. They had been scouting him. They wanted to know that he could hit a long ball and, this day, he hit it for them.

How he happened to hit that homerun is something for meteorologists to explain. Perhaps it was a rare condition of the atmosphere such as accounts for "Denver homeruns." Scouts all follow the rule, "Don't judge a hitter by what he does in Denver."

The light atmosphere there makes every spanked horseshoe take off as if it had been peeled from the back of Pegasus.

NOT AN APPLEKNOCKER

AT ANY RATE ANDY DID NOT HIT enough long balls in the Polo Grounds to suit McGraw or the New York fans. He stayed with the Giants for three years and was a regular second baseman for two. During his two terms as a regular the Giants finished second and third.

Since then Andy has been one of the good troupers of baseball.

As player, coach or manager, he has flitted about the big and little minors. He has had some of the best minor league jobs, some not so good. To each job he has given the same enthusiasm and concentration. He has always been a baseball man, using his wits to make the most of each situation. In all these years no team with which Andy was connected lost a game because Andy wasn't trying.

GOT JOB DONE

HE WAS A THINKING BALL PLAYER who got everything out of himself.

He could not range so far as many other second basemen; but he got in front of as many ground balls as they did because he knew more about the hitters.

He did not have as strong an arm as some; but he got the doubleplays made because there was not the smallest fraction of a second lost in his pivot and throw.

He was never a mighty hitter; but he was a mean man to have at the plate if any kind of play was on. He'd get something done.

The late Mike Kelley used to say, "Andy's smaht, he's smaht. He makes the big play for you. He knows what the opponent is trying to do and won't let him do it. Never remember Andy making a dumb play. Remember plenty of the other kind."

Steady, dependable and smart were the words for Andy in his playing days, and in his managing days as well.

BACK TO MAYORS

HE LEFT THE NATIONAL LEAGUE in 1930. He returns as a coach for Philadelphia in 1960.

In between he has served baseball loyally, wisely and well.

For guest of honor at last night's baseball banquet there could not have been a better choice. No one ever speaks of Minneapolis' past in baseball without thinking first of the teams of Andy's time; and no one ever mentions the many fine second basemen Minneapolis has had without some chuckling memories of Andy's clever plays.

BARTON RECALLS 'BOSTON DECISIONS'

GEORGE BARTON, FAMOUS FORMER referee and boxing commissioner, goes along with remarks here about the Ray Robinson-Paul Pender decision last Friday.

"Back as far as 1910," Barton said, "whenever a fighter got a bad decision anywhere in the country he would say he got a 'Boston decision.' That expression, 'Boston decision,' has been in the boxing vernacular all this time.

"Mike O'Dowd went to his grave," Barton continued, "still protesting that it was a 'Boston decision' which let Johnny Wilson lift his middleweight championship; and here, all these years later, Paul Pender wins a middleweight championship on a Boston decision although, the way it looked to me, if Robinson did not lose the 12th round, which is questionable, he did not lose a round."